

90-DAY ENTRY PLAN | Portfolio Director, Software Integration Office — The Aerospace Corporation

Because SIO is a brand-new organization, my first 90 days are about earning trust, gaining full visibility into the portfolio, and standing up a disciplined but lightweight operating rhythm *before* scaling execution — the same sequence I used to build portfolio management discipline from scratch across a fragmented, 100+ application portfolio at the USDA. This plan is a starting hypothesis, not a fixed script; I will pressure-test it with the team and adjust in the first two weeks.

Guiding Principles

- Listen before changing anything — understand how SIO and its people actually work before introducing new process.
- Build lightweight, sustainable practices, not heavy process for its own sake.
- Create visible early wins while investing in long-term portfolio capability.
- Develop people alongside process — coaching TPMs is part of the operating rhythm from day one, not an afterthought.

DAYS 1–30 Listen, Learn, and Assess

Focus: build relationships and get an honest, first-hand picture of the portfolio, the team, and the customer landscape before proposing any changes.

- Complete 1:1s with every TPM, SIO leadership, and key ISCD stakeholders; begin relationships with priority customers.
- Inventory all 5–10 active projects — scope, deliverable type (software, systems engineering, technical analysis), status, budget, and risk.
- Assess current reporting, governance, and communication practices (or the lack of them, given SIO is new) to identify what to keep, fix, or build.
- Shadow customer engagement and strategy sessions to understand voice-of-customer and how SIO's charter translates into day-to-day priorities.
- Identify one or two quick wins — a stalled deliverable to unblock, a reporting gap to close — to build early credibility without overreaching.

30-DAY DELIVERABLE: A portfolio baseline assessment, stakeholder relationship map, and initial risk register, shared with SIO leadership.

DAYS 31–60 Design, Align, and Stand Up the Operating Rhythm

Focus: convert what I learned in the first 30 days into a working portfolio management practice, built with the team rather than imposed on it.

- Stand up reporting cadences, status-review formats, and stakeholder communication practices sized to a 5–10 project portfolio — disciplined, not bureaucratic.
- Establish governance controls for cost, schedule, and scope tracking, with clear escalation paths.
- Build individual development plans with each TPM — creating stretch opportunities for early- and mid-career high performers, and a growth path for the most senior TPMs.
- Begin contributing directly to SIO work products: customer portfolio analyses and ISCD capability offerings.
- Get fluent in the SIO tech-investment planning cycle and the full RFP-to-close-out execution path for at least one active project.
- Socialize the new practices with customers and stakeholders; adjust based on what actually helps them, not just what looks good on paper.

60-DAY DELIVERABLE: A live portfolio management framework in use across all active projects, individual TPM development plans, and a first authored contribution to SIO strategy documentation.

DAYS 61–90 Execute, Demonstrate Value, and Set the Next Roadmap

Focus: run the portfolio end-to-end under the new operating rhythm and show SIO leadership concrete proof it's working.

- Take full accountability for on-time, on-budget delivery across the entire portfolio under the new reporting and governance model.
- Lead the first complete status-review and reporting cycle end-to-end, incorporating stakeholder feedback from the prior 60 days.
- Deliver the first complete customer portfolio analysis or capability offering as a finished SIO work product.
- Formalize the TPM coaching cadence and identify the first concrete leadership growth opportunity for a high-performing TPM.
- Bring forward specific, evidence-based input on SIO's organizational structure and business processes as the organization matures.
- Present a 90-day results summary and a proposed roadmap for the next quarter to SIO and ISCD leadership.

90-DAY DELIVERABLE: A fully operational portfolio management practice, demonstrated stakeholder confidence, and an agreed roadmap for the next 90 days.

90 Days at a Glance

DAY 30	DAY 60	DAY 90
– Relationship map built across TPMs, SIO leadership, ISCD, and key customers – Full inventory and risk assessment of the 5–10 project portfolio – Baseline understanding of SIO strategy and charter	– Portfolio reporting cadence, status reviews, and stakeholder comms live – TPM coaching plans in place for every team member – First contribution to SIO strategy work products	– Full ownership of on-time, on-budget delivery across the portfolio – First completed customer portfolio analysis delivered – Next-quarter roadmap presented to leadership

How I'll Measure Success

- Every active project tracked on-time and on-budget against committed milestones, with no surprises in status reviews.
- Portfolio reporting and governance practices adopted and trusted by TPMs, SIO leadership, and customers alike.
- Measurable growth for at least one TPM — a new scope of ownership, a stretch assignment, or a step toward promotion.
- Direct, visible contributions to SIO's customer strategy and technical investment planning, not just portfolio execution.
- SIO leadership has clear, evidence-based input to keep shaping the organization's structure and processes as it matures.